I FLEW TO TORONTO. End of October 2016. Meg was excited to show me *her* life, *her* dogs—*her* little house, which she adored. And I was eager to see it all, to know every last detail about her. (Though I'd snuck into Canada once before, briefly, this would be my first proper visit.) We walked the dogs in big, open ravines and parks. We explored the sparsely populated nooks and crannies of her neighborhood. Toronto wasn't London, but it also wasn't Botswana. So, be ever cautious, we said. Maintain the bubble. Keep wearing disguises.

Speaking of disguises. We invited Euge and Jack to join us for Halloween. And Meg's best friend Markus. Toronto's Soho House was having a big party and the theme was "Apocalypse." Dress accordingly.

I mumbled to Meg that I'd not had great luck with themed fancy-dress parties, but I'd give it another go. For help with my costume, I'd turned to a friend, the actor Tom Hardy, before I left home. I'd phoned him to ask if I could borrow his costume from *Mad Max*.

The whole thing?

Yes, please, mate! The whole kit.

He'd given it all to me before I left Britain, and now I tried it on in Meg's little bathroom. When I came out, she roared with laughter.

It was funny. And a little scary. But the main thing was: I was unrecognizable.

Meg, meanwhile, wore torn black shorts, a camo top, fishnet stockings. If that's the Apocalypse, I thought, bring on the end of the world.

The party was loud, dark, drunk—ideal. Several people did double-takes as Meg passed through the rooms, but no one looked twice at her dystopian date. I wished I could wear this disguise every day. I wished I could reuse it the next day and visit her on the set of *Suits*.

Then again, maybe not. I'd made the mistake of googling and watching some of her love scenes online. I'd witnessed her and a castmate mauling each other in some sort of office or conference room…It would take electric-shock therapy to get those images out of my head. I didn't need to see such things live. Still, the point was moot: the next day was Sunday, so she wasn't working.

And then everything was rendered moot, everything was changed forever, because the next day was when news of our relationship broke wide open.